

SAFEGUARDING POLICY

INSTITUTE FOR SUSTAINABLE SOCIOECONOMIC TRANSFORMATION OF AFRICA (ISSTA)



Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)
P.O.Box 189587 Kampala/ P.O.Box 57 Lira
East Africa, Uganda
Tel: +256777725444
E-mail dredward@isstaug.org/isstaceo780@gmail.com
<https://isstaug.org>

January 2025

ISSTA Organogram

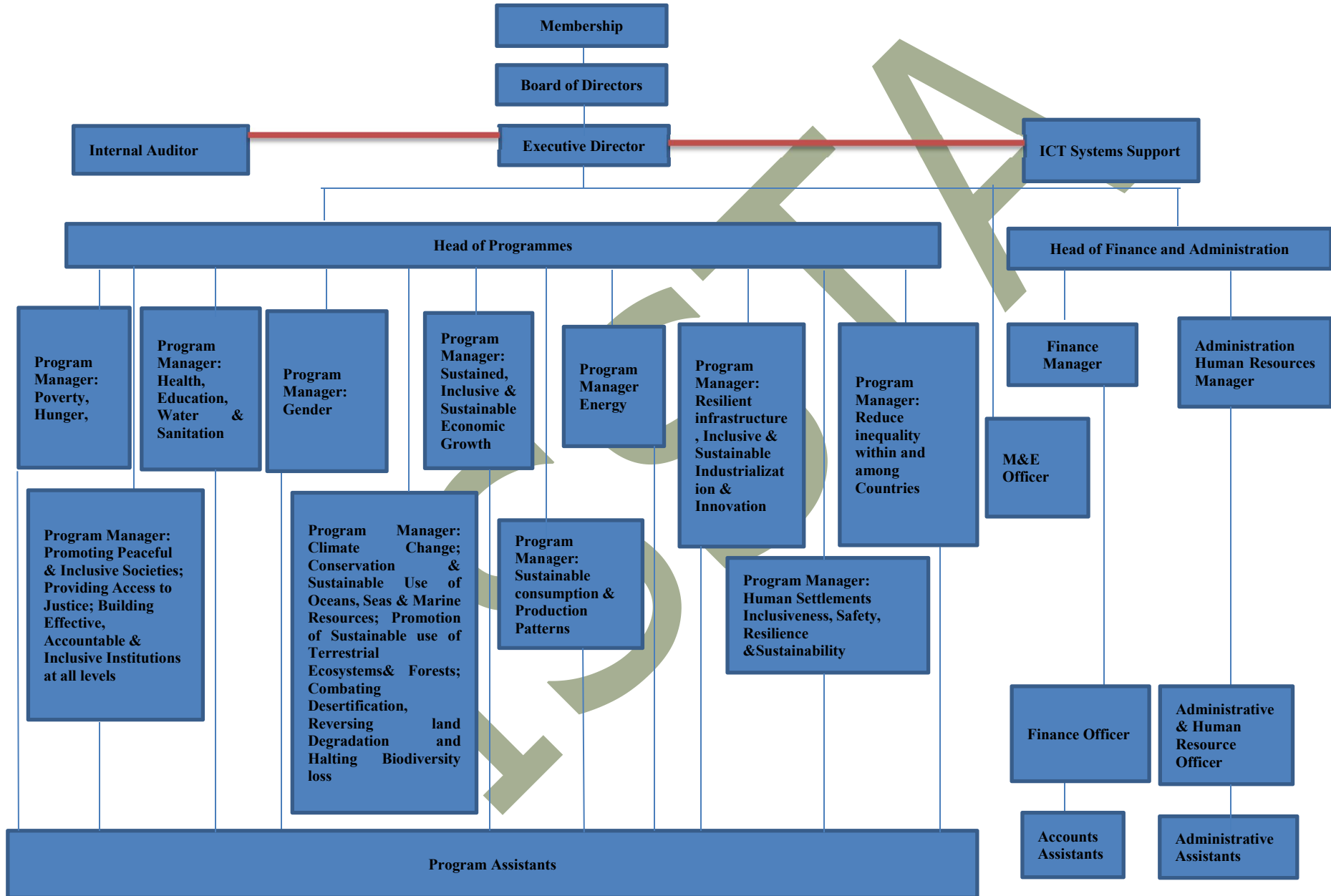


TABLE OF CONTENTS

No.	Particulars	Page
	ORGANOGRAM OF ISSTA	ii
1.0	BACKGROUND	1
2.0	PURPOSE	1
3.0	ISSTA KEY OBJECTIVE	1
4.0	ISSTA SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES	1
5.0	ISSTA TARGET GROUP	2
6.0	SAFEGUARDING POLICY FRAMEWORK	2
6.1	Foundational Safeguarding Principles	2
6.2	Safeguarding Standards	2
6.2.1	Do No Harm	2
6.2.2	Anti-Exploitation	2
6.2.3	Safe Recruitment	2
6.2.4	Reporting Mechanisms	2
6.2.5	Empowerment	2
6.2.6	Prevention	2
6.2.7	Proportionality	
6.2.8	Protection	3
6.2.9	Partnership	3
6.2.10	Accountability	3
6.2.11	Child Protection	3
6.2.12	Anti-Transactional Sex	3
6.2.13	Power Dynamics	3
6.2.14	Mandatory Reporting	3
6.2.15	Environment of Prevention	3
6.2.16	Safe Recruitment	3
6.2.17	Safe Design	3
6.2.18	Informed Consent	3
6.2.19	Confidentiality	3
6.2.20	Support is relevant and appropriate to people's needs	3

1.0 BACKGROUND

ISSTA has a mission to make contributions to social development and as such, promotes inclusive growth through facilitating small holder farmers (SHFs) to mobilize themselves into feasible grassroots socioeconomic structures, mainly Cooperatives and Village Savings and Loans Associations (VSLAs), under specific value chains, producing and marketing food and tradable products like grain, cocoa, coffee, fish, fruits, and natural ingredients for cosmetics and pharmaceuticals. This approach has proven useful for poverty eradication, Food and Nutrition Security (FNS), and transforming SHFs' mindsets from subsistence to focused commercial activity. ISSTA also works to improve the target group's operating environment by building civic engagement capacities, which impact service delivery, sustainable environment resource use, democratic practice, human rights, peace, and justice.

2.0 PURPOSE

ISSTA's Purpose is to localise sustainable development in all its facets, through the identification of socioeconomic problems and stakeholders' participatory design and implementation of interventions that ensure inclusive growth amongst grassroots communities in Uganda, and across Africa

3.0 ISSTA KEY OBJECTIVE

To catalyse social development with inclusive growth by mobilising smallholder farmers, cooperatives, and MSMEs, to engage in market-focused value chains and promote agribusiness, food and nutrition security, sustainable environmental use, and civic engagement

4.0 ISSTA SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES

- (i) To mobilise smallholder farmers (SHFs) in the formation of cooperatives for competitive agribusiness, with women, youth, and deprived persons' inclusion and engaging in participatorily selected feasible value chains
- (ii) To mainstream food and nutrition security, and prudent environmental resources use through the promotion of sustainable and conservation agriculture among target groups activity
- (iii) To build community-based capacities in engaging duty bearers towards the promotion of service delivery, human rights, peace, and justice

5.0 ISSTA TARGET GROUP

ISSTA works with development stakeholders who include grassroots communities, funders from all countries of the world, regional development blocks, central governments, local governments, academia, faith-based organisations, International and National NGOs, and

6.0 SAFEGUARDING POLICY FRAMEWORK

6.1 Foundational Safeguarding Principles

Civic Engagement and Human Rights - ISSTA promotes civic engagement specifically to drive improvements in human rights, peace, and justice.

Protection of Vulnerable Groups - The organization's mission includes "ending killer diseases among children and adults" and addressing gender imbalance and poverty.

Inclusive Growth - Their model focuses on facilitating farmers to form economic entities like Village Savings and Loans Associations (VSLAs) and Cooperatives, which are designed to provide safe and equitable economic environments for rural workers.

6.2 Safeguarding Standards

Based on ISSTA work with rural communities and vulnerable populations in Africa, ISSTA typically adheres to standard international non-profit safeguarding practices to ensure safety, dignity, and rights of everyone it serves. These principles are primarily categorized into Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA), general Child Safeguarding, and broader Humanitarian Standards.

6.2.1 Do No Harm - which ensures that staff, volunteers, and partners do not cause harm to the communities they serve.

6.2.2 Anti-Exploitation - which places strict prohibitions against sexual exploitation, abuse, and harassment (SEAH) in all development programs.

6.2.3 Safe Recruitment - ensuring background checks for staff working directly with children or vulnerable adults.

6.2.4 Reporting Mechanisms - provide procedures for community members or staff to report grievances or safety concerns without fear of retaliation.

6.2.5 Empowerment - supporting individuals to make their own decisions and give informed consent.

6.2.6 Prevention - taking action before harm occurs rather than just reacting to it.

6.2.7 Proportionality - ensuring the response is balanced and the least intrusive possible for the level of risk.

6.2.8 Protection - providing support and representation for those in the greatest need.

6.2.9 Partnership - working with local services and communities to find collective solutions.

6.2.10 Accountability - maintaining transparency in all safeguarding practices and taking responsibility for outcomes.

6.2.11 Child Protection - strictly prohibiting sexual activity with anyone under 18, regardless of local laws.

6.2.12 Anti-Transactional Sex - forbids exchanging money, employment, or goods for sex, including sexual favors.

6.2.13 Power Dynamics - prohibits sexual relationships between aid workers and beneficiaries that involve improper use of rank or position

6.2.14 Mandatory Reporting - obligating all staff to report concerns or suspicions of SEA through established agency channels.

6.2.15 Environment of Prevention - Managers are responsible for maintaining a workplace culture that prevents abuse and implements codes of conduct.

6.2.16 Safe Recruitment - vetting all staff through background checks and criminal record searches.

6.2.17 Safe Design - ensuring all programs and projects are risk-assessed to minimize harm to children.

6.2.18 Informed Consent - Obtaining voluntary agreement from parents or legal guardians for services involving minors.

6.2.19 Confidentiality - Restricting photographs or video recordings and protecting child survivors' identities.

6.2.20 Support is relevant and appropriate to people's needs - ensuring that support: is effective and timely; strengthens local capacities and resilience; does no harm to people or the environment; includes a safe reporting system of concerns and having them addressed; is coordinated and complementary; is continually improved based on feedback; is provided by staffs who are respectful, competent, and well-managed; driven by resources that are managed ethically and responsibly.